

I Bind Unto Myself Today

Words: attributed to St. Patrick of Ireland (circa 387-466). Paraphrased by Cecil F. Alexander, 1889.
Music: 'St. Patricks Breastplate' Charles V. Stanford, 1902. Setting: "The English Hymnal", 1906.
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♩ = 120

1. I bind un - to my - self to - - day The strong Name of the
2. I bind this day to me for - - ev - er By pow - er of faith, Christ's
3. I bind un - to my - self the pow - er Of the great love
4. I bind un - to my - self to - - day The vir - - tues of the
5. I bind un - to my - self to - - day The pow - er of God to

Tri - - ni - - ty,
in - - car - - na - - tion;
cher - - u - - bim;
star lit heav - en,
hold and lead,
By in - - vo - - ca - - - tion
His bap - - tism in the
The sweet "Well done" in
The glor - - ious sun's life
His eye to watch, His

The first system of the musical score consists of three staves. The top staff is a vocal line in E-flat major, starting with a half note G4, followed by quarter notes A4 and B4, then a half note C5, and ending with a half note B4. The piano accompaniment is in E-flat major and features a steady eighth-note bass line in the left hand and chords in the right hand.

The second system is marked with a first ending bracket labeled '1'. It contains three staves. The vocal line has a whole note G4. The piano accompaniment consists of a whole note chord in the right hand and a whole note chord in the left hand.

The third system is marked with a 2-9 bracket. It contains three staves. The vocal line has a long melisma consisting of a half note G4 and a half note A4. The piano accompaniment consists of a whole note chord in the right hand and a whole note chord in the left hand. The lyrics are: same riv - - - - er, ho - - - - ur, ray, stay,

The first system of music consists of a vocal line and a piano accompaniment. The key signature is B-flat major (two flats). The vocal line begins with a whole note G4. The piano accompaniment consists of a right hand with a whole note chord of G4-Bb4 and a left hand with a whole note G3.

The second system of music continues the vocal and piano parts. The vocal line has a half note G4, a half note A4, a quarter note Bb4, and a quarter note G4. The piano accompaniment features a right hand with chords of G4-Bb4, G4-Bb4, and G4-Bb4, and a left hand with a half note G3, a half note A3, a quarter note Bb3, and a quarter note G3.

The third system of music includes a vocal line and a piano accompaniment. The vocal line has a half note G4, a half note A4, a quarter note Bb4, and a quarter note G4. The piano accompaniment features a right hand with chords of G4-Bb4, G4-Bb4, and G4-Bb4, and a left hand with a half note G3, a half note A3, a quarter note Bb3, and a quarter note G3.

2. His burst - - - ing from the
3. Con - - - fes - - - sors' faith, A - -
4. The flash - - - ing of of the
5. The wis - - - dom of my

The fourth system of music continues the vocal and piano parts. The vocal line has a half note G4, a half note A4, a quarter note Bb4, and a quarter note G4. The piano accompaniment features a right hand with chords of G4-Bb4, G4-Bb4, and G4-Bb4, and a left hand with a half note G3, a half note A3, a quarter note Bb3, and a quarter note G3.

up - pray - ers, the heav'n - ly way, His com - - - ing
wind's guide, the tem - - pest - - uous shocks, All good - - - deeds
His shield to ward; The sta - - - ble of
The word - - - ble of

7

6. Against the demon snares of sin,
The vice that gives temptation force,
The natural lusts that war within,
The hostile men that mar my course;
Or few or many, far or nigh,
In every place and in all hours,
Against their fierce hostility
I bind to me these holy powers.
7. Against all Satan's spells and wiles,
Against false words of heresy,
Against the knowledge that defiles,
Against the heart's idolatry,
Against the wizard's evil craft,
Against the death wound and the burning,
The choking wave, the poisoned shaft,
Protect me, Christ, till Thy returning.

8. Christ be with me, Christ within me,
Christ behind me, Christ before me,
Christ beside me, Christ to win me,
Christ to comfort and restore me.
Christ beneath me, Christ above me,
Christ in quiet, Christ in danger,
Christ in hearts of all that love me,
Christ in mouth of friend and stranger.

9. I bind unto myself the Name,
The strong Name of the Trinity,
By invocation of the same,
The Three in One and One in Three.
By Whom all nature hath creation,
Eternal Father, Spirit, Word:
Praise to the Lord of my salvation,
Salvation is of Christ the Lord.